

Vaibhav Raheja

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Robotics Systems Engineer with 2+ years building and deploying autonomous platforms across hardware-software architecture, multi-sensor perception, and production field operations. Strong across ROS2-based autonomy, multi-sensor fusion (LiDAR, thermal, PTZ), and full-stack robotics infrastructure, with field-proven results achieving 90% uptime and 40% improvement in fault detection rates.

WORK EXPERIENCE

TerraWise Solutions, Inc, *Founding Engineer*

Mar 2026 – Present | San Francisco, CA

- Building TerraWise's autonomous robotics stack from scratch, establishing ROS2 architecture and Docker deployment workflows following an internal transition from EarthSense.
- Defining hardware-software standards and foundational perception pipelines, drawing on multi-sensor integration and field deployment experience from Solarbot.
- Migrating the full platform to NVIDIA Jetson, integrating ODrive motor controllers, and implementing LiDAR-based stop-by-obstacle detection.

EarthSense, Inc, *Robotics Engineer / Project Lead*

Aug 2024 – Mar 2026 | Champaign, USA

- Led a cross-functional Solarbot team of 8+ engineers to deliver an autonomous solar panel inspection system across 3+ multi-site robot units.
- Validated sensor performance in extreme thermal conditions (43–46°C) across multiple solar farm field deployments.
- Hardened safety-critical motion control and telemetry by shipping 35+ PRs across the C++ and Python robotics stack.
- Enabled low-latency remote monitoring via an AWS Kinesis WebRTC teleoperation proof of concept.
- Integrated multi-sensor perception stacks (Hesai/Unitree LiDAR, PTZ cameras, Seek thermal) into production via ROS2 and Docker.

Intelligent Motion Laboratory, *Robotics Research Developer*

Aug 2023 – Dec 2023 | Champaign, USA

- Achieved sub-2mm tracking accuracy for autonomous robotic eye examinations using MediaPipe FaceMesh and ZED depth cameras on UR5.
- Designed a custom camera mount in Fusion 360 for the UR5, improving head tracking precision by 20%.

All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) Hospital, *Robotics Research Developer, NMIMS*

Feb 2021 – May 2023 |

Mumbai, India

- Engineered a robot-assisted intubation system on xArm5 with HOTAS teleoperation and real-time camera feedback for critical care.
- Fabricated a custom catheter end-effector with integrated miniature camera for real-time airway visualization.

SKILLS

Programming: Python, C++, ROS/ROS2, OpenCV, PyTorch, Machine Learning (ML), CNNs

Robotics & Perception: LiDAR Integration (Hesai), Multi-Sensor Fusion, Camera Calibration, Path Planning, Motion Planning, Control Algorithms, Reinforcement Learning, Gazebo, SLAM, Docker

Tools: Linux, Git, Fusion 360, CAD, Arduino, Raspberry Pi, 3D Printing

PROJECTS

Benchmarking Control Algorithms for Unitree Go1 Robot

Python, ISAAC Sim, Reinforcement Learning | 2024

- Built an ISAAC Sim benchmarking framework for the Unitree Go1, comparing factory vs. RL-based locomotion across velocity tracking, stability, and terrain adaptability.
- Validated RL controller performance by deploying "Walk These Ways" on a physical Go1 across grass, gravel, and inclines.

GRAIC Autonomous Racing

Python, Hybrid A*, Path Planning, PD Control, Vehicle Dynamics | 2023

- Achieved 40.8% lap time improvement on the Shanghai circuit using a Hybrid A* path planner tuned to vehicle kinematics and non-holonomic dynamics.
- Benchmarked three algorithms (Hybrid A*, Dynamic Programming, Spline Interpolation) and tuned a PD controller for steering and velocity.

Intelligent Ground Vehicle Competition (IGVC), Team DARVIN

Python, ROS, OpenCV, ODrive, Velodyne LiDAR, Gazebo |

2019–2023

- Served as Co-Captain, securing 2nd in the Cyber Challenge (2023) and 3rd in the Auto-Nav Challenge (2022) against 15+ international university teams.
- Developed SOCRATES 2.0 on ROS with Velodyne LiDAR avoidance, OpenCV lane detection, GPS navigation, and ODrive S1 motor control, Gazebo-validated and field-deployed.

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Aug 2023 – Dec 2024 | Champaign, USA

Master of Engineering in Autonomy and Robotics

Mukesh Patel School of Technology Management & Engineering

Jul 2019 – Jun 2023 | Mumbai, India

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Engineering

PUBLICATIONS

V. Raheja, V. Shah, M. Shetty, and P. Patel, "Multi-Disease Prediction System using Machine Learning," 2022 *International Conference on Futuristic Technologies (INCOFT)*, Belgaum, India, 2022, pp. 1–6. doi: 10.1109/INCOFT55651.2022.10094382